

SENATE BILL 2122

By Bowling

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49,
relative to school nutrition.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1.

The Tennessee K-12 nutrition task force is hereby established to evaluate the prevalence of ultra-processed foods (UPFs) and other substances in public school meal programs and the impact of UPFs on student health.

SECTION 2.

(a) The task force shall consist of nine (9) members, appointed as follows:

(1) Two (2) members appointed by the chair of the senate health and welfare committee;

(2) Two (2) members appointed by the chair of the committee of the house of representatives having jurisdiction over health matters;

(3) Two (2) members appointed by the chair of the senate education committee;

(4) Two (2) members appointed by the chair of the committee of the house of representatives having jurisdiction over grade kindergarten through twelve (K-12) matters; and

(5) One (1) member representing the Tennessee department of education, appointed by the commissioner of education.

(b) A member of the task force must not have a financial interest in, or a conflict of interest with, any food, beverage, or pharmaceutical manufacturing company.

(c) The member appointed pursuant to subdivision (a)(5) shall call the first meeting of the task force.

(d) At its first meeting, the task force shall elect a chair and vice chair from among the appointed members.

(e) A majority of the members of the task force constitutes a quorum for the transaction of business.

(f) The members of the task force receive no compensation for their service on the task force, nor are the members entitled to per diem or travel expenses for the purposes of carrying out their duties under this act.

(g) A member of the task force shall serve until the task force completes its business and ceases to exist pursuant to Section 5. If a member of the task force is unable to continue to serve, then the authority that appointed the member shall appoint a replacement.

SECTION 3.

The task force shall:

(1) Identify the percentage of UPFs, artificial dyes, and chemical additives currently included in K-12 school breakfasts and lunches;

(2) Review clinical data regarding the link between UPF consumption in schools and rising rates of childhood obesity and metabolic dysfunction; and

(3) Develop actionable recommendations to transition school menus toward whole-food alternatives.

SECTION 4.

No later than December 1, 2026, the task force shall submit a final report of its findings and legislative recommendations to the governor and the legislative librarian, in order to ensure consideration prior to the 2027 legislative session.

SECTION 5.

The Tennessee K-12 nutrition task force ceases to exist on January 31, 2027.

SECTION 6. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.